

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Emergency Provisions - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Three constitutional emergencies

National - Article 352

War, external aggression or
armed rebellion

State - Article 356

Government cannot be
carried on according to
Constitution

Financial - Article 360

Threat to financial
stability or credit

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Polity 14 - Emergency Provisions - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** 14 | **GS-II + Prelims** | **Content control:** 2026-08-28 **Approval:** false - awaiting explicit user approval. **Evidence key:** [FACT] constitutional, judicial or source-verified proposition; [ANALYSIS] reasoned exam synthesis; [CURRENT] dated status; [LIMIT] qualification preventing overstatement.

Package method, scope boundary and current control

- Source order followed: certified Core owner Polity/basic/Emergency-Provisions.md -> optional Advanced owner Polity/advanced/14_Emergency-Provisions.md -> official/local PYQ routes and recent official key -> Constitution, judgments and current controls -> Qdrant not used.
- [LIMIT] Foundation and Core are independently answer-complete. Optional Advanced adds Constituent Assembly criticism and deeper theory only.
- [CURRENT] Status is controlled to **28 August 2026, Asia/Kolkata**.
- [CURRENT] *S.R. Bommai (1994)*, the 44th Amendment safeguards and *K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)*'s rejection of *ADM Jabalpur (1976)* remain controlling.
- [CURRENT] No National Emergency or Financial Emergency is in force. India has never proclaimed a Financial Emergency under Article 360. President's Rule imposed in Manipur on 13 February 2025 was revoked on **4 February 2026**, restoring elected government; State-specific Article 356 status must always be dated rather than treated as permanent history.
- [CURRENT] 25 June is officially observed as **Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas**, commemorating resistance to abuse during the 1975 Emergency; this is commemorative policy, not a constitutional amendment.
- [LIMIT] Centre-State relation mechanics are cross-linked to Polity 13; Governor office to Polity 19; Fundamental Rights doctrine to Polity 07. Every emergency-specific rule remains complete here.
- Package target: **6 routed PYQs, 28 original MCQs, 8 remedials, 7 original solved Mains questions, 10 guided Mains answers and 14 original visuals**.

Roadmap

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Overview	Three emergencies and constitutional purpose	Prevents category mixing
National trigger	War, external aggression, armed rebellion and imminent danger	Solves Article 352 stems
Procedure	Written Cabinet advice, approval, renewal and revocation	Masters numbers and majorities
Effects	Executive, legislative, financial, tenure and federal effects	Builds Mains analysis
Rights	Articles 358 and 359, 20/21 shield, ADM Jabalpur (1976)	Solves hardest traps
History	1962, 1971, 1975 and 38th/42nd/44th Amendments	Explains safeguards
President's Rule	Trigger, approval, consequences and duration	Solves Article 356
S.R. Bommai (1994)	Review, floor test, dissolution and restoration	Answers 2023 GS-II
Decline	Legal, political and commission factors	Completes causal analysis
Financial	Trigger, consequences and never-used status	Answers 2018 GS-II
Comparison	352 versus 356 versus 360	Rapid revision
Advanced	Criticism, constitutional dictatorship and safety-valve debate	Optional analytical lift
Practice	Six PYQs, 36 MCQs and ten guided Mains models	Converts knowledge into marks

Scope ownership and cross-links

- **Polity 07:** general Fundamental Rights, preventive detention and writs.
- **Polity 12:** federalism and Basic Structure.
- **Polity 13:** Article 355, 365 and Union directions as Centre-State relations.
- **Polity 19:** Governor reports, government formation and floor-test procedure.
- [LIMIT] Cross-linking prevents repetition, not missing knowledge.

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Polity Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Text hierarchy	Constitution/Act/rule/notification -> binding judgment -> authoritative institution -> Constituent Assembly material -> standard textbook.
Legal precision	State exact Article, Part, Schedule, amendment, case, date, institution, procedure, exception and current operative status.
Doctrine method	Text -> institutional mechanism -> controlling case -> exception/limit -> present legal status.
Chronology	Enactment, commencement, amendment, judgment and implementation dates remain separate.
Boundary method	Topic ownership and cross-owner bridges are explicit; adjacent PYQs never become fabricated direct routes.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, examiner-grade model, timed compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\basic\Emergency-Provisions.md
Canonical topic owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\basic\Emergency-Provisions.md **Optional**
Advanced owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\advanced\14_Emergency-Provisions.md **Official**
syllabus mapping: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Four independent ledgers:** literal syllabus/index, indispensable prerequisites, standard textbook taxonomy and complete routed 2018-2026 PYQ demands were built before repair.
- **Hostile search:** missing Articles, Parts, Schedules, amendments, cases, institutional mechanisms, exceptions, chronology, source status and cross-owner boundaries are hard failures.
- **Answer rule:** claim -> exact constitutional/statutory/case evidence -> institutional analysis -> exception or qualification.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-05:** Rechecked 2026-09-05: no National Emergency or Financial Emergency was located in force. The Gazette of India proclamation dated 4 February 2026 revoked the Manipur Article 356 proclamation issued on 13 February 2025. The post-44th Amendment text and S.R. Bommai (1994) review remain controlling.

Authoritative live sources:

- <https://legislative.gov.in/documents/constitution-of-india>
- <https://egazette.gov.in/WriteReadData/2026/269819.pdf>
- <https://www.mha.gov.in/en>
- https://api.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2012/35071/35071_2012_Judgement_24-Aug-2017.pdf

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - WHY EMERGENCY PROVISIONS EXIST

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Emergency provisions are constitutional crisis tools for national security, State breakdown or grave financial threat.

Technical definition: Part XVIII preserves constitutional government by temporarily altering ordinary powers under Articles 352, 356 or 360.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Emergency provisions defend the Constitution only when exceptional power remains temporary, reviewable and directed toward normal government.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Part XVIII
- Article 352
- Article 356
- Article 360
- constitutional crisis
- limited government

How to use them: Frame the answer through Part XVIII; define Article 352, connect Article 356 with Article 360 to explain the mechanism, and use constitutional crisis for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Three constitutional emergencies



The Constitution provides national, State and financial emergencies for distinct failures.

Type	Article	Trigger
National Emergency	352	War, external aggression or armed rebellion threatens security of India or part
President's Rule	356	State government cannot be carried on according to the Constitution
Financial Emergency	360	Financial stability or credit of India or part is threatened

- [FACT] Part XVIII contains Articles 352-360.
- [ANALYSIS] Emergency provisions preserve the constitutional order by temporarily centralising authority; they do not create an extra-constitutional regime.
- [ANALYSIS] Ambedkar described the Constitution as capable of being federal or unitary according to circumstances.
- [LIMIT] "State Emergency" and "Constitutional Emergency" are descriptive names for Article 356, not headings used in Article 356.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - WHY EMERGENCY PROVISIONS EXIST

START / CONCEPT: Why emergency provisions exist

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v

EXACT TERMS: Part XVIII · Article 352 · Article 356 · Article 360 · constitutional crisis · limited government

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v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Classify the failure first, then apply its separate trigger, approval, duration, effects and revocation rules.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Different emergencies centralise different functions without creating an extra-constitutional regime.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat the three emergencies as one interchangeable power.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Emergency provisions defend the Constitution only when exceptional power remains temporary, reviewable and directed toward normal government.

SESSION 2 - NATIONAL EMERGENCY: TRIGGER AND TERRITORIAL SCOPE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 352 addresses threats from war, external aggression or armed rebellion to India or any part.

Technical definition: A proclamation may anticipate imminent danger and may cover the whole or a specified part of India.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

National Emergency begins with a narrow constitutional ground, not a general claim of internal disturbance.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 352**
- **war**
- **external aggression**
- **armed rebellion**
- **imminent danger**
- **territorial scope**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 352; define war, connect external aggression with armed rebellion to explain the mechanism, and use imminent danger for the decisive comparison or qualification.

- [FACT] Article 352 permits proclamation where security of India or any part is threatened by war, external aggression or armed rebellion.
- [FACT] A proclamation may issue before the actual occurrence if imminent danger exists.
- [FACT] War/external aggression is commonly called external Emergency; armed rebellion is internal Emergency.
- [FACT] The 44th Amendment replaced vague "internal disturbance" with "armed rebellion."
- [FACT] The 42nd Amendment permits an Emergency to operate in the whole or a specified part of India.
- [LIMIT] "Internal disturbance" remains in Article 355 but is no longer a National Emergency ground.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NATIONAL EMERGENCY: TRIGGER AND TERRITORIAL SCOPE

START / CONCEPT: National Emergency: trigger and territorial scope

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v

EXACT TERMS: Article 352 · war · external aggression · armed rebellion · imminent danger · territorial scope

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Match the asserted threat to the constitutional ground and stated territorial operation.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A valid trigger activates only the separately defined emergency consequences.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Internal disturbance remains in Article 355 but is not an Article 352 ground.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: National Emergency begins with a narrow constitutional ground, not a general claim of internal disturbance.

SESSION 3 - NATIONAL EMERGENCY PROCEDURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 352 procedure combines written Cabinet initiation, special-majority approval, six-month renewal and revocation controls.

Technical definition: Each House must approve within one month, and continuance requires recurring special-majority resolutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

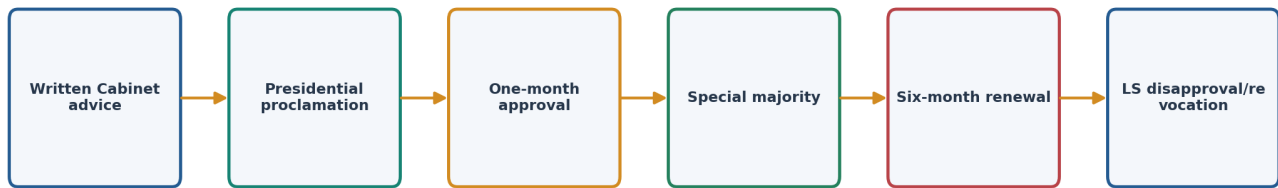
National Emergency cannot continue on executive will alone.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- written Cabinet advice
- one month
- special majority
- six months
- Lok Sabha disapproval
- revocation

How to use them: Frame the answer through written Cabinet advice; define one month, connect special majority with six months to explain the mechanism, and use Lok Sabha disapproval for the decisive comparison or qualification.

National Emergency process



Article 352 now requires written Cabinet advice, prompt special-majority approval and recurring renewal.

Written Cabinet recommendation

- [FACT] The President cannot issue a proclamation unless the decision of the Union Cabinet to issue it has been communicated in writing.
- [FACT] "Cabinet" here means the Council consisting of the Prime Minister and Cabinet-rank ministers; the Prime Minister alone cannot constitutionally trigger Article 352.

Approval and renewal

- [FACT] Each House must approve within one month.
- [FACT] Approval and every six-month continuation require a special majority: majority of total House membership plus at least two-thirds of members present and voting.
- [FACT] Once approved, it continues six months and can be renewed indefinitely in six-month blocks.
- [FACT] If Lok Sabha is dissolved during the approval window, Rajya Sabha approval preserves the proclamation until 30 days after the first sitting of the reconstituted Lok Sabha, which must approve it.

Revocation and Lok Sabha disapproval

- [FACT] The President may revoke by subsequent proclamation; revocation needs no parliamentary approval.
- [FACT] If Lok Sabha passes a disapproval resolution by simple majority, the President must revoke.
- [FACT] At least one-tenth of Lok Sabha members may give notice seeking a special sitting; the sitting must be held within 14 days.
- [LIMIT] This special disapproval mechanism belongs to National Emergency, not Article 356.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NATIONAL EMERGENCY PROCEDURE

START / CONCEPT: National Emergency procedure

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v

EXACT TERMS: written Cabinet advice • one month • special majority • six months • Lok Sabha disapproval • revocation

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace written decision, proclamation, parliamentary approval, periodic renewal and exit.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Recurring legislative legitimacy and lower-House control restrain the executive.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not use the simple-majority or two-month rules of Articles 356 and 360.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: National Emergency cannot continue on executive will alone.

SESSION 4 - THE 44TH AMENDMENT SAFEGUARD ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The 44th Amendment repaired the principal procedural and liberty failures exposed by the 1975 Emergency.

Technical definition: It narrowed the ground, required written Cabinet advice, strengthened approval, protected Articles 20-21 and restored review.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The 44th Amendment converted emergency discretion into a more rule-bound constitutional power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- 44th Amendment
- armed rebellion
- Cabinet in writing
- special majority
- Articles 20 and 21
- judicial review

How to use them: Frame the answer through 44th Amendment; define armed rebellion, connect Cabinet in writing with special majority to explain the mechanism, and use Articles 20 and 21 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

44th Amendment safeguards after 1975



The 44th Amendment narrowed grounds, strengthened procedure, protected liberty and restored review.

Pre-1978 vulnerability	44th Amendment response
"Internal disturbance" was vague	Replaced with armed rebellion
Prime-ministerial advice could dominate	Written Cabinet decision required
Two-month/simple-majority approval	One-month/special-majority approval
Weak lower-House exit	Lok Sabha disapproval forces revocation
Article 19 suspension too broad	Article 358 confined to external Emergency and emergency-related laws
Court enforcement could be blocked for life/personal liberty	Articles 20 and 21 excluded from Article 359
Satisfaction immunity after 38th Amendment	Immunity removed; judicial review restored

- [ANALYSIS] The 44th Amendment did not abolish emergency government; it converted political discretion into a more rule-bound and reviewable power.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE 44TH AMENDMENT SAFEGUARD ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: The 44th Amendment safeguard architecture

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EXACT TERMS: 44th Amendment · armed rebellion · Cabinet in writing · special majority · Articles 20 and 21 · judicial review

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Link each pre-1978 vulnerability to its specific constitutional repair.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Emergency power survives, but its activation and rights effects are more tightly controlled.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not attribute the pro-liberty safeguards to the 42nd Amendment.

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↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The 44th Amendment converted emergency discretion into a more rule-bound constitutional power.

SESSION 5 - EFFECTS OF NATIONAL EMERGENCY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: National Emergency expands Union executive, legislative and financial reach while State governments and legislatures continue.

Technical definition: Articles 353-354, Article 250 and tenure provisions temporarily alter ordinary federal operation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

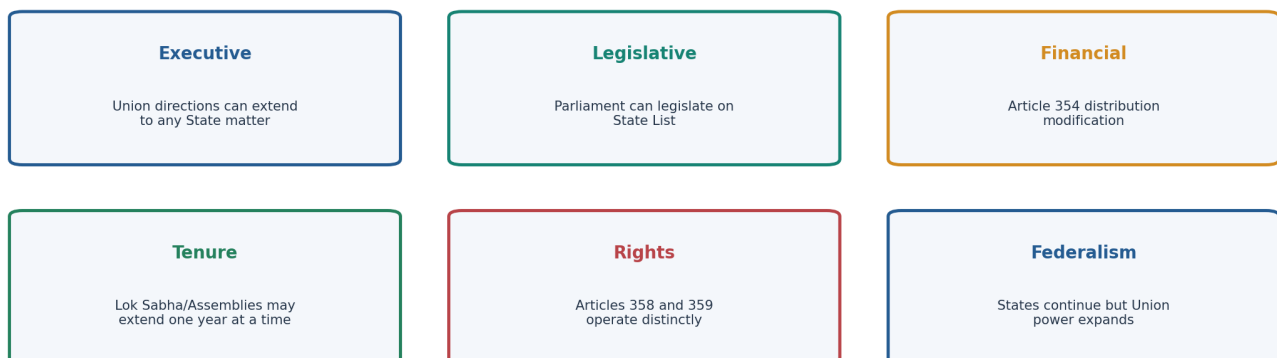
Article 352 makes the federation temporarily Union-weighted; it does not abolish States.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 353
- Article 354
- Article 250
- revenue distribution
- legislative terms

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 353; define Article 354, connect Article 250 with revenue distribution to explain the mechanism, and use legislative terms for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Effects of a National Emergency



National Emergency expands Union executive, legislative and financial power while States continue to exist.

Executive

- [FACT] Union executive power extends to giving directions to any State on the manner in which State executive power is exercised.
- [FACT] After the 42nd Amendment, this effect can extend beyond the territory where the Emergency is operative where security is affected by activities connected to that territory.

Legislative

- [FACT] Parliament may legislate on State List matters under Article 250.
- [FACT] State legislatures continue; parliamentary competence becomes concurrent for the period.
- [FACT] Such parliamentary law ceases to have effect six months after the Emergency ends, except for completed acts.
- [FACT] The President may promulgate ordinances on State subjects when Parliament is not in session.

Financial

- [FACT] Article 354 permits the President to modify application of Articles 268-279 revenue-distribution provisions during the Emergency.
- [FACT] An order cannot extend beyond the financial year in which the proclamation ceases and must be laid before Parliament.

Legislative terms

- [FACT] Parliament may extend Lok Sabha and State Assembly terms by one year at a time during National Emergency.
- [FACT] No such extension can continue beyond six months after the Emergency ceases.
- [LIMIT] Emergency does not automatically extend terms; Parliament must enact the extension.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - EFFECTS OF NATIONAL EMERGENCY

START / CONCEPT: Effects of National Emergency

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v

EXACT TERMS: Article 353 · Article 354 · Article 250 · revenue distribution · legislative terms

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Separate executive directions, State-field legislation, revenue orders and term extensions.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: National coordination increases while completed acts and constitutional institutions remain protected by limits.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Term extension and State-list legislation are authorised steps, not automatic effects.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Article 352 makes the federation temporarily Union-weighted; it does not abolish States.

SESSION 6 - FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS: ARTICLE 358 VERSUS ARTICLE 359

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Articles 358 and 359 create different, carefully bounded rights consequences during National Emergency.

Technical definition: Article 358 concerns Article 19 in war or external aggression; Article 359 requires a presidential court-enforcement order.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Rights doctrine must distinguish disapplication of Article 19 limits from suspension of a court-enforcement route.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 358
- Article 359
- Article 19
- presidential order
- Articles 20 and 21
- emergency nexus

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 358; define Article 359, connect Article 19 with presidential order to explain the mechanism, and use Articles 20 and 21 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Article 358 versus Article 359

358 scope Article 19 only	358 trigger War/external aggression only	358 mode Automatic, subject to post-44th nexus/recital
359 scope Specified rights except Articles 20 and 21	359 trigger Either kind of National Emergency	359 mode Presidential order suspends court enforcement

Article 358 automatically affects Article 19 in external Emergency; Article 359 depends on a presidential enforcement order.

Test	Article 358	Article 359
Right affected	Article 19 only	Rights named in presidential order except 20 and 21
Trigger	War/external aggression Emergency only	Either external or armed-rebellion Emergency
Operation	Automatic	Requires presidential order
Constitutional effect	Article 19 restrictions do not constrain qualifying emergency-related law/action	Right to move specified courts for enforcement is suspended as ordered
Territorial/duration scope	Emergency operation subject to constitutional text	Whole/part and period stated in order

Post-44th nexus protection

- [FACT] Article 358 protection applies only to laws containing the required recital that they relate to the proclamation and executive action under such law.
- [FACT] Similar recital-linked protection applies to emergency laws under Article 359(1A).
- [ANALYSIS] Ordinary unrelated illegality does not receive an Emergency shield.

Articles 20 and 21

- [FACT] Article 359 cannot suspend court enforcement of Articles 20 and 21.
- [FACT] Protection against retrospective penal law/double jeopardy/self-incrimination and life/personal liberty therefore remain judicially enforceable.
- [LIMIT] Article 358 never concerned Articles 20 or 21; it concerns Article 19.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS: ARTICLE 358 VERSUS ARTICLE 359

START / CONCEPT: Fundamental Rights: Article 358 versus Article 359

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v

EXACT TERMS: Article 358 · Article 359 · Article 19 · presidential order · Articles 20 and 21 · emergency nexus

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Compare trigger, operation, right, territorial scope, duration and post-44th recital requirement.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Emergency-related action receives limited protection while life and liberty remain enforceable.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not say all Fundamental Rights or the rights themselves are automatically suspended.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Rights doctrine must distinguish disapplication of Article 19 limits from suspension of a court-enforcement route.

SESSION 7 - ADM JABALPUR (1976), KHANNA AND K.S. PUTTASWAMY (2017)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: ADM Jabalpur (1976), Khanna and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) trace the movement from executive finality to an enforceable liberty core.

Technical definition: ADM Jabalpur (1976) denied the enforcement route during 1975; Khanna dissented; K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) overruled the majority approach.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

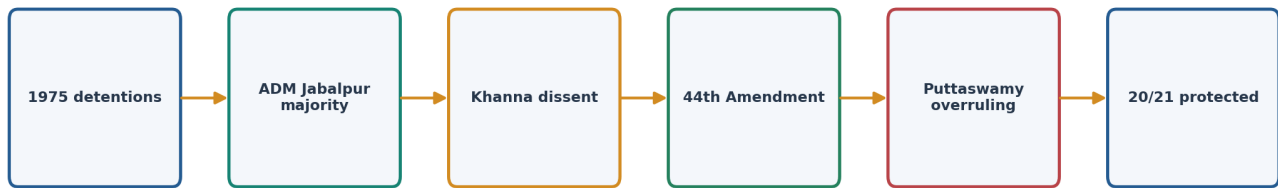
The Constitution now answers ADM Jabalpur (1976) through both the 44th Amendment and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- ADM Jabalpur (1976)
- H.R. Khanna
- habeas corpus
- 44th Amendment
- K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)
- Article 21

How to use them: Frame the answer through ADM Jabalpur (1976); define H.R. Khanna, connect habeas corpus with 44th Amendment to explain the mechanism, and use K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Liberty doctrine after the 1975 Emergency



The constitutional trajectory moved from denial of habeas corpus to permanent protection of life and liberty.

- [FACT] During the 1975 Emergency, the *ADM Jabalpur (1976)* majority held that a detained person could not seek habeas corpus for enforcement of Article 21 while the relevant Article 359 order operated.
- [FACT] Justice H.R. Khanna dissented, affirming that life and liberty are not dependent solely on executive grace.
- [FACT] The 44th Amendment constitutionally protected Articles 20 and 21 from Article 359 suspension.
- [FACT] *K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)* expressly held *ADM Jabalpur (1976)* wrongly decided and overruled it.
- [ANALYSIS] The correction is both textual and jurisprudential: non-suspendability plus recognition that constitutional liberty survives executive emergency claims.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ADM JABALPUR (1976), KHANNA AND K.S. PUTTASWAMY (2017)

START / CONCEPT: ADM Jabalpur (1976), Khanna and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)

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v

EXACT TERMS: ADM Jabalpur (1976) · H.R. Khanna · habeas corpus · 44th Amendment · K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) · Article 21

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v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Explain the 1976 holding, dissent, textual repair and 2017 overruling in sequence.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Articles 20 and 21 cannot be removed from judicial enforcement through Article 359.

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v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: ADM Jabalpur (1976) is historical warning, not good current law.

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v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Constitution now answers ADM Jabalpur (1976) through both the 44th Amendment and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017).

SESSION 8 - HISTORICAL DECLARATIONS AND AMENDMENT TIMELINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: India experienced National Emergency proclamations in 1962, 1971 and 1975, followed by constitutional correction.

Technical definition: The 38th sought satisfaction immunity, the 42nd expanded emergency operation and the 44th restored safeguards.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The declaration and amendment timeline explains why present doctrine is stricter than the 1975 framework.

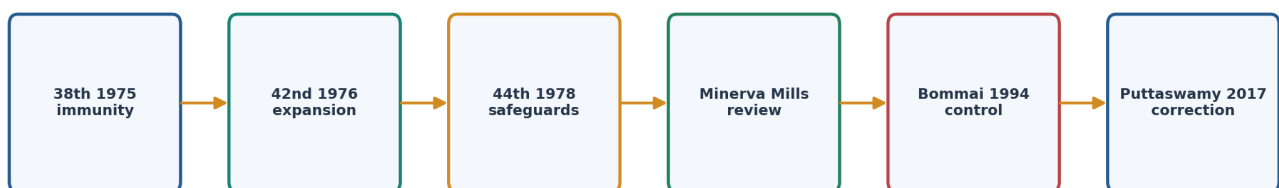
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- 1962 Emergency
- 1971 Emergency
- 1975 Emergency
- 38th Amendment
- 42nd Amendment
- 44th Amendment

How to use them: Frame the answer through 1962 Emergency; define 1971 Emergency, connect 1975 Emergency with 38th Amendment to explain the mechanism, and use 42nd Amendment for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Declaration	Ground/context	Control point
1962	External aggression during China conflict	Continued until 1968
1971	External aggression during Pakistan conflict	Continued alongside 1975 proclamation
1975	Internal disturbance under pre-44th text	Most controversial; ended in 1977

Emergency amendment timeline



The emergency Constitution moved from immunity and expansion to safeguards, review and liberty correction.

- [FACT] 38th Amendment (1975): attempted to make presidential satisfaction final and non-justiciable.
- [FACT] 42nd Amendment (1976): permitted territorially limited proclamation and broadened effects.
- [FACT] 44th Amendment (1978): added the principal democratic safeguards.
- [FACT] *Minerva Mills* recognised review of emergency satisfaction for mala fides or wholly extraneous grounds.
- [CURRENT] 25 June is officially observed as Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas to commemorate those who resisted abuse during the 1975 Emergency.
- [CURRENT] No Article 352 proclamation is in force as of 28 August 2026. President's Rule in Manipur (imposed 13 February 2025) was revoked on 4 February 2026; this recent State-specific episode must not be confused with National Emergency.
- [LIMIT] The official observance changes no Emergency Article.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HISTORICAL DECLARATIONS AND AMENDMENT TIMELINE

START / CONCEPT: Historical declarations and amendment timeline

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EXACT TERMS: 1962 Emergency · 1971 Emergency · 1975 Emergency · 38th Amendment · 42nd Amendment · 44th Amendment

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Connect each proclamation or amendment to its trigger, overlap, effect and later correction.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Historical misuse produced procedural, federal and liberty safeguards.

|

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: no National Emergency is in force as of 28 August 2026.

|

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The declaration and amendment timeline explains why present doctrine is stricter than the 1975 framework.

SESSION 9 - PRESIDENT'S RULE: TRIGGER AND PROCEDURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: President's Rule addresses State constitutional machinery that cannot operate according to the Constitution.

Technical definition: Article 356 uses a Governor report or other material, two-month simple-majority approval and bounded renewals.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

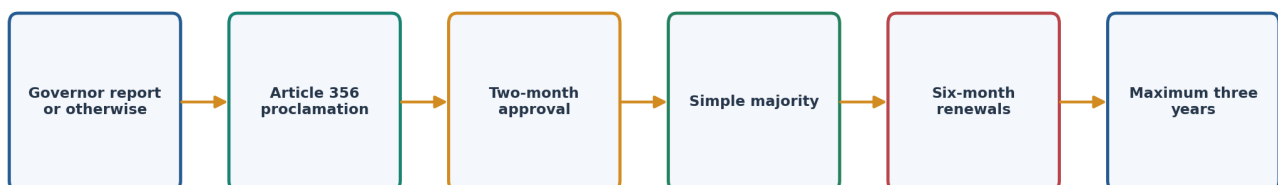
President's Rule is a State-specific exceptional remedy, not a response to ordinary political disagreement.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 356
- Governor report
- or otherwise
- two months
- simple majority
- three years

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 356; define Governor report, connect or otherwise with two months to explain the mechanism, and use simple majority for the decisive comparison or qualification.

President's Rule process



Trigger

- [FACT] The President must be satisfied that State government cannot be carried on according to the Constitution.
- [FACT] Satisfaction may arise on the Governor's report or otherwise.
- [FACT] Article 355 supplies the Union duty to protect States and ensure constitutional government; Article 365 concerns failure to comply with Union directions.
- [LIMIT] Political disagreement or maladministration alone is not automatically constitutional breakdown.

Approval and duration

- [FACT] Both Houses must approve within two months by simple majority.
- [FACT] If Lok Sabha is dissolved during the approval window, Rajya Sabha approval can preserve it until 30 days after the reconstituted Lok Sabha first sits.
- [FACT] Once approved, it continues six months at a time.
- [FACT] Maximum duration is three years.
- [FACT] Extension beyond one year requires both: a National Emergency operating in whole India or whole/part of the State, and Election Commission certification that Assembly elections cannot be held.
- [FACT] The President may revoke at any time without parliamentary approval.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRESIDENT'S RULE: TRIGGER AND PROCEDURE

START / CONCEPT: President's Rule: trigger and procedure

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 356 · Governor report · or otherwise · two months · simple majority · three years

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Test objective material, approval, six-month renewal, one-year conditions and revocation.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Union intervention can preserve constitutional government but remains parliament-controlled.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Article 365 supplies possible material; it does not automatically impose President's Rule.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: President's Rule is a State-specific exceptional remedy, not a response to ordinary political disagreement.

SESSION 10 - CONSEQUENCES OF PRESIDENT'S RULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: President's Rule shifts State executive and legislative functions without transferring High Court power or suspending Fundamental Rights.

Technical definition: Articles 356-357 permit presidential assumption and parliamentary exercise or delegation of State legislative authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The consequences of President's Rule preserve the State's constitutional identity and laws during temporary Union administration.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 357
- Parliament

- Assembly suspension
- Assembly dissolution
- High Court

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 357; define Parliament, connect Assembly suspension with Assembly dissolution to explain the mechanism, and use High Court for the decisive comparison or qualification.

- [FACT] The President may assume State executive functions and Governor powers, except High Court functions.
- [FACT] The State Council of Ministers is dismissed.
- [FACT] The President may declare State legislative powers exercisable by or under Parliament's authority.
- [FACT] Parliament may confer legislative power on the President and authorise further delegation.
- [FACT] The Assembly may be suspended or dissolved, but *S.R. Bommai (1994)* bars irreversible dissolution before parliamentary approval.
- [FACT] State laws made during President's Rule continue after revocation until altered or repealed by competent authority.
- [FACT] President may authorise expenditure from the State Consolidated Fund pending parliamentary sanction where necessary.
- [LIMIT] Article 356 has no automatic Article 19 or other Fundamental Rights suspension.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CONSEQUENCES OF PRESIDENT'S RULE

START / CONCEPT: Consequences of President's Rule

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 357 • Parliament • Assembly suspension • Assembly dissolution • High Court

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Separate executive assumption, legislative authority, expenditure, Assembly status and continuing laws.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The elected ministry may be displaced, but judicial and federal safeguards remain.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: irreversible Assembly dissolution should await parliamentary approval.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The consequences of President's Rule preserve the State's constitutional identity and laws during temporary Union administration.

SESSION 11 - S.R. BOMMAI (1994): THE CONTROLLING ARTICLE 356 DOCTRINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: S.R. Bommai (1994) converted Article 356 from largely political discretion into reviewable constitutional power.

Technical definition: The case requires relevant material, floor testing, delayed dissolution and effective restoration where appropriate.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

S.R. Bommai (1994) protects federalism and representative majority by making emergency satisfaction justiciable.

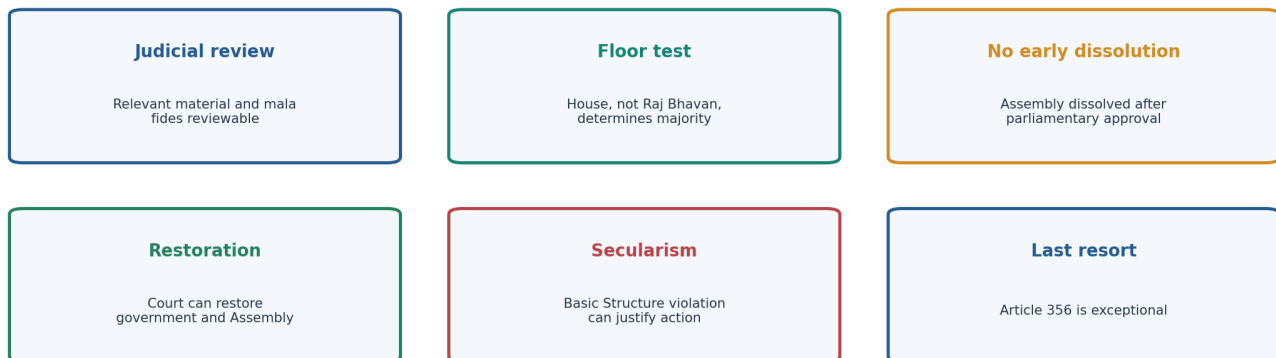
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- S.R. Bommai (1994)
- judicial review
- relevant material

- floor test
- restoration
- federalism

How to use them: Frame the answer through S.R. Bommai (1994); define judicial review, connect relevant material with floor test to explain the mechanism, and use restoration for the decisive comparison or qualification.

S.R. Bommai control matrix



S.R. Bommai (1994) converted Article 356 from largely political discretion into reviewable, floor-tested constitutional power.

1. Presidential proclamation is judicially reviewable.
2. Satisfaction must rest on relevant material; the Union must produce material when challenged.
3. Mala fide or irrelevant-material action is invalid.
4. Legislative majority should ordinarily be tested on the Assembly floor.
5. Assembly should not be dissolved before Parliament approves the proclamation.
6. Court can restore the government and Assembly after invalid proclamation.
7. Article 356 is an exceptional, last-resort power.
8. A new Union government cannot dismiss State governments merely for political difference.
9. Secularism is Basic Structure; anti-secular State action can have Article 356 relevance.
10. Parliamentary approval does not completely exclude judicial review.

Rameshwar Prasad (2006)

- [FACT] The Supreme Court held the 2005 Bihar Assembly dissolution unconstitutional based on an unreliable/mala fide preventive assessment of possible majority formation.
- [LIMIT] The Court did not restore the dissolved Assembly because elections had advanced; the case still demonstrates review of Governor-based material.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - S.R. BOMMAI (1994): THE CONTROLLING ARTICLE 356 DOCTRINE

START / CONCEPT: S.R. Bommai (1994): the controlling Article 356 doctrine

|

v

EXACT TERMS: S.R. Bommai (1994) · judicial review · relevant material · floor test · restoration · federalism

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Apply review, majority, parliamentary approval, remedy and secularism propositions to the facts.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Partisan dismissal becomes legally risky and institutionally reversible.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: S.R. Bommai (1994) does not prohibit Article 356 when genuine constitutional breakdown is proved.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: S.R. Bommai (1994) protects federalism and representative majority by making emergency satisfaction justiciable.

SESSION 12 - WHY ARTICLE 356 USE DECLINED AFTER THE MID-1990S

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 356 use declined because judicial review and political federalisation jointly raised the cost of misuse.

Technical definition: S.R. Bommai (1994) and Rameshwar Prasad (2006) combined with coalitions, regional parties and commission norms.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

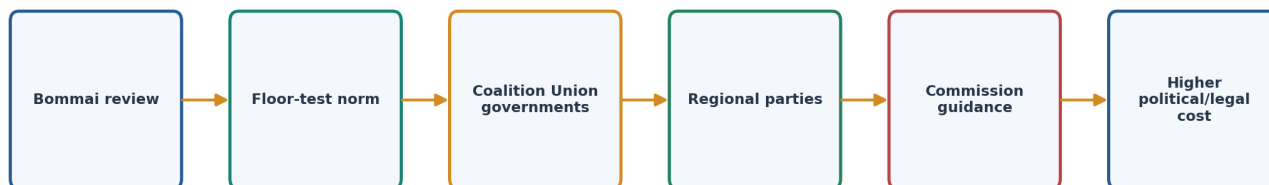
The decline reflects changed incentives, not repeal of the constitutional power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 356 decline
- S.R. Bommai (1994)
- Rameshwar Prasad (2006)
- coalition politics
- regional parties
- Sarkaria Commission

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 356 decline; define S.R. Bommai (1994), connect Rameshwar Prasad (2006) with coalition politics to explain the mechanism, and use regional parties for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Why Article 356 declined after the mid-1990s



Judicial review, floor tests, coalitions, regional parties and commission norms jointly raised the cost of misuse.

Factor	Mechanism
<i>S.R. Bommai (1994)</i> review	Irrelevant or mala fide proclamations risk invalidation and restoration
Floor-test rule	Governor's subjective majority assessment loses finality
Coalition era	Union governments depended on regional allies
Regional-party strength	State dismissals carried national coalition costs
Sarkaria/Punchhi norms	Warning, floor test and last-resort standards gained legitimacy
Media/civil society	Partisan use became more visible and politically costly

- [ANALYSIS] The decline was produced without removing Article 356: law changed incentives while political federalisation changed costs.
- [LIMIT] Reduced frequency does not mean the controversy has disappeared; Governor/floor-test disputes remain litigated.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - WHY ARTICLE 356 USE DECLINED AFTER THE MID-1990S

START / CONCEPT: Why Article 356 use declined after the mid-1990s

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 356 decline • S.R. Bommai (1994) • Rameshwar Prasad (2006) • coalition politics • regional parties • Sarkaria Commission

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Organise the answer into legal, political and institutional causes.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Conflict shifted toward Governors, assent, finance and agencies even as proclamations became rarer.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Rameshwar Prasad (2006) invalidated dissolution but did not restore the Assembly because elections had advanced.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The decline reflects changed incentives, not repeal of the constitutional power.

SESSION 13 - FINANCIAL EMERGENCY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 360 is a last-resort response to threatened financial stability or credit of India or any part.

Technical definition: It requires two-month simple-majority approval and permits financial-propriety, salary and State-Bill directions.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Financial Emergency is constitutionally severe precisely because it centralises finance without periodic renewal.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 360
- financial stability
- credit
- financial propriety
- salary reduction

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 360; define financial stability, connect credit with financial propriety to explain the mechanism, and use salary reduction for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Financial Emergency architecture



Article 360 combines a broad financial trigger with drastic and indefinite central directions.

Trigger and procedure

- [FACT] The President may proclaim if financial stability or credit of India or any part is threatened.
- [FACT] Both Houses must approve within two months by simple majority.
- [FACT] Lok Sabha dissolution receives the same Rajya Sabha/30-day reconstituted-House continuity logic.
- [FACT] Once approved, it continues indefinitely without periodic renewal.
- [FACT] The President may revoke at any time; revocation needs no parliamentary approval.
- [FACT] Presidential satisfaction is subject to constitutional judicial review after repeal of the 38th Amendment immunity.

Consequences

- [FACT] Union executive power extends to directions requiring States to observe canons of financial propriety and other necessary directions.
- [FACT] Directions may require reduction of salaries and allowances of all or any class serving a State.
- [FACT] Directions may require State Money Bills and other specified financial Bills to be reserved for presidential consideration.

- [FACT] President may direct reduction of salaries and allowances of all or any class serving Union affairs, including Supreme Court and High Court judges.
- [FACT] No Financial Emergency has ever been proclaimed.
- [LIMIT] The 1991 crisis is a comparison point, not an invocation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FINANCIAL EMERGENCY

START / CONCEPT: Financial Emergency

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 360 · financial stability · credit · financial propriety · salary reduction

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace trigger, approval, indefinite duration, directions, revocation and never-used status.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The Union can impose exceptional fiscal discipline while ordinary institutions remain available first.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: India has never proclaimed Article 360; the 1991 crisis was managed without it.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Financial Emergency is constitutionally severe precisely because it centralises finance without periodic renewal.

SESSION 14 - THREE-EMERGENCY COMPARISON

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Articles 352, 356 and 360 differ in trigger, majority, renewal, maximum duration and constitutional effect.

Technical definition: Comparison prevents transfer of National-Emergency rules to State or Financial Emergency.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Three-emergency comparison separates the distinct constitutional procedures hidden by the shared emergency label.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 352
- Article 356
- Article 360
- special majority
- simple majority
- duration

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 352; define Article 356, connect Article 360 with special majority to explain the mechanism, and use simple majority for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Emergency comparison

352 Special majority; indefinite renewals; FR and federal effects	356 Simple majority; max three years; State machinery	360 Simple majority; indefinite; financial directions
High Court Unaffected by Article 356 assumption	Revocation Different parliamentary controls	Core test Trigger, approval, duration, effects, safeguards

Each emergency differs in trigger, majority, duration, effect and revocation.

Test	National - 352	President's Rule - 356	Financial - 360
Approval window	1 month	2 months	2 months
Majority	Special	Simple	Simple
Renewal	Every 6 months	Every 6 months	None
Maximum	Indefinite	3 years	Indefinite
Main effect	Union/federal/rights expansion	State executive/legislature control	Financial directions
Fundamental Rights	Articles 358/359 may operate	No direct effect	No direct effect
High Court	Continues	Cannot be assumed	Judges' salaries may be reduced
Forced lower-House revocation	Lok Sabha mechanism	No equivalent	No equivalent

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THREE-EMERGENCY COMPARISON

START / CONCEPT: Three-emergency comparison

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Article 352 · Article 356 · Article 360 · special majority · simple majority · duration

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Compare each provision across the same trigger-procedure-effect-revocation columns.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Precise classification closes the most common Prelims and Mains errors.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: only Article 352 has the special Lok Sabha disapproval mechanism.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Three-emergency comparison separates the distinct constitutional procedures hidden by the shared emergency label.

SESSION 15 - COMMISSION SAFEGUARDS AND CONSTITUTIONAL ALTERNATIVES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sarkaria and Punchhi treat Article 356 as a last resort after warning, consultation and floor-tested alternatives.

Technical definition: Commission recommendations reinforce, but do not replace, constitutional text and binding case law.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

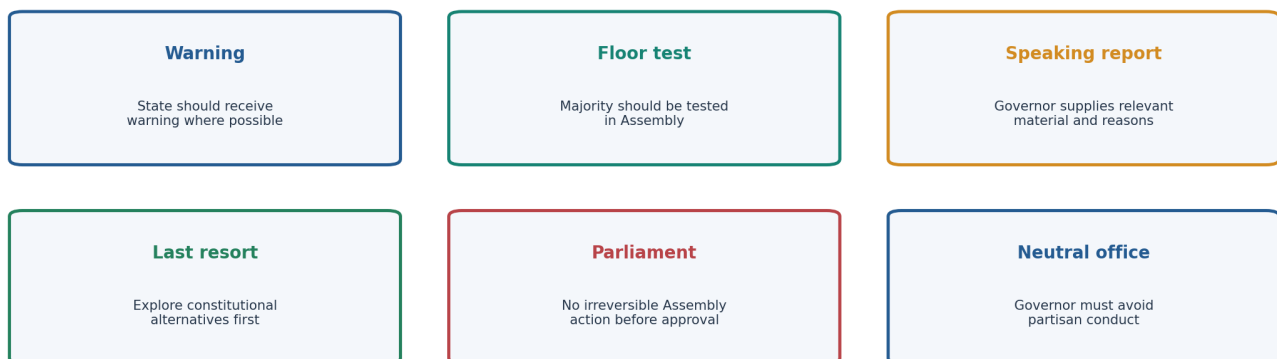
Emergency legitimacy depends on exhausting narrower constitutional remedies where feasible.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sarkaria Commission
- Punchhi Commission
- warning
- floor test
- speaking report
- last resort

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sarkaria Commission; define Punchhi Commission, connect warning with floor test to explain the mechanism, and use speaking report for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Sarkaria and Punchhi safeguards



Sarkaria and Punchhi emphasise warning, floor test, speaking reports, last resort and neutral Governorship.

- Issue a warning to the State where feasible.
- Use Article 356 only after less drastic constitutional alternatives fail.
- Test majority on the Assembly floor.
- Governor report should be reasoned and based on verifiable material.
- Avoid dissolving Assembly before parliamentary approval.
- Distinguish political instability from constitutional impossibility.
- Maintain political neutrality in Governor appointment and conduct.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMMISSION SAFEGUARDS AND CONSTITUTIONAL ALTERNATIVES

START / CONCEPT: Commission safeguards and constitutional alternatives

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sarkaria Commission · Punchhi Commission · warning · floor test · speaking report · last resort

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Match the alleged failure to consultation, judicial, legislative or targeted ordinary-law alternatives.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A restrained escalation ladder preserves both Union capacity and State democracy.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not present unimplemented commission recommendations as binding law.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Emergency legitimacy depends on exhausting narrower constitutional remedies where feasible.

POLITY HOSTILE SEMANTIC-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Teach Articles 352-360 as three different regimes with exact triggers, approval periods, renewal, revocation, maximum duration, federal effects and rights consequences; Articles 358 and 359 must never be merged.
- **Close distinction:** The 44th Amendment replaced internal disturbance with armed rebellion, requires written Cabinet advice, protects Articles 20 and 21, narrows Article 358 to war/external aggression and creates the Lok Sabha revocation route; Article 356 still has its own six-month approval cycle.
- **Legal/source limit:** As of 5 September 2026 no National or Financial Emergency was located in force. The Gazette proclamation of 4 February 2026 revoked the Manipur Article 356 proclamation; retain S.R. Bommai (1994) review and floor-test discipline without converting every political crisis into constitutional breakdown.

Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Part XVIII map:** Article 352 is National Emergency; Articles 353-354 state

its executive, legislative and revenue effects; Article 355 is the Union duty; Articles 356-357 govern State constitutional failure; Articles 358-359 govern specified rights effects; Article 360 is Financial Emergency.

- **Article 352:** only war, external aggression or armed rebellion qualify.

Written Union-Cabinet advice, one-month parliamentary approval by special majority, six-month renewals, revocation and the one-tenth Lok Sabha notice route inserted by the 44th Amendment must remain exact.

- **Rights firewall:** Article 358 concerns Article 19 only, operates automatically

only during war/external-aggression emergency, and protects only emergency-related law/action carrying the required recital. Article 359 requires a Presidential order and cannot suspend enforcement of Articles 20 and 21.

- **Article 356:** the proclamation needs parliamentary approval within two months, continues in six-month blocks and ordinarily cannot exceed three years; beyond one year the Article 356(5) conditions apply. Parliament assumes legislative power but High Court jurisdiction cannot be taken over.

- **Judicial control:** S.R. Bommai (1994) makes the proclamation reviewable and prefers a floor test for disputed majority; Rameshwar Prasad (2006) condemns premature dissolution. Article 355, Article 365 and a Governor's report do not create automatic failure.

- **ADM Jabalpur (1976):** the majority's habeas-corpus approach is repudiated; Justice H.R. Khanna's dissent is vindicated and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) records the overruling. Do not use the case to negate the express post-44th Article 20/21 protection.

- **Article 360:** two-month parliamentary approval and indefinite continuation until revocation are textually distinct from Article 352/356. It has never been proclaimed and does not automatically suspend Fundamental Rights.

- **Current status:** the Gazette proclamation dated 4 February 2026 revoked the Manipur Article 356 proclamation of 13 February 2025. No National Emergency or Financial Emergency was located in force on 5 September 2026.
- **Four-ledger hostile audit:** triggers, dates, amendment history, cases, rights effects, federal consequences, commissions, current proclamations and every routed 2018-2026 demand were independently checked.
- **PYQ boundary:** the 2018 Article 356 objective demand is direct; the 2023 detention/POTA demand is retained only as an expressly supporting route and no direct Mains question is fabricated.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original hard MCQ set - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Emergency grounds

Which is a current Article 352 ground?

A. Armed rebellion B. Internal disturbance C. Financial instability D. Failure of State machinery

Answer: A.

The 44th Amendment replaced internal disturbance with armed rebellion.

OM2. Imminent danger

A National Emergency:

A. cannot apply to part of India B. may be proclaimed before occurrence where imminent danger exists C. requires completed invasion D. needs Governor consent

Answer: B.

Article 352 expressly covers imminent danger.

OM3. Cabinet advice

The President may proclaim National Emergency only after:

A. Supreme Court approval B. PM oral advice C. written Union Cabinet decision communicated D. Rajya Sabha request

Answer: C.

This is a post-1975 44th Amendment safeguard.

OM4. Approval majority

National Emergency approval requires:

A. State ratification B. two-thirds total membership C. simple majority D. majority of total membership plus two-thirds present and voting

Answer: D.

The special majority applies to approval and six-month continuation.

OM5. Approval window

Both Houses must approve Article 352 within:

A. one month B. 14 days C. six months D. two months

Answer: A.

Pre-44th it was two months; now one.

OM6. Renewal

Once approved, National Emergency continues:

A. one year maximum B. six months per special-majority renewal C. until Supreme Court review D. indefinitely without vote

Answer: B.

There is no maximum if valid six-month renewals continue.

OM7. Disapproval notice

A special Lok Sabha sitting can be requisitioned by at least:

A. one-third members B. one-half members C. one-tenth members D. 50 members regardless of strength

Answer: C.

It must be held within 14 days.

OM8. Ground distinction

Which statement is correct?

A. Armed rebellion triggers Article 356 only. B. Financial Emergency affects Article 19. C. Article 355 no longer uses internal disturbance. D. Article 358 applies only to war/external aggression Emergency.

Answer: D.

Article 358 does not operate for armed rebellion.

OM9. Executive effect

During National Emergency, Union executive power may:

A. direct States on exercise of executive power B. abolish State List C. dismiss every State ministry automatically D. take over High Courts

Answer: A.

States continue, but Union directions expand.

OM10. State-list law

Parliamentary State-list law under Emergency ordinarily ceases:

A. after one year B. six months after Emergency ends C. only if State repeals D. immediately

Answer: B.

Completed acts remain protected.

OM11. Article 354

It permits:

A. dissolution of Rajya Sabha B. suspension of Article 21 C. temporary modification of constitutional revenue distribution D. creation of Financial Emergency

Answer: C.

The order is temporally bounded and laid before Parliament.

OM12. Term extension

Lok Sabha/Assembly term extension during Emergency:

A. can be five years at once B. is automatic C. continues forever D. may be one year at a time and not beyond six months after cessation

Answer: D.

Parliament must legislate the extension.

OM13. Article 358

Which is correct?

A. It automatically concerns Article 19. B. It needs a presidential order. C. It suspends all Fundamental Rights. D. It operates in Article 356.

Answer: A.

Post-44th it is external-Emergency and nexus-limited.

OM14. Article 359

It principally permits the President to:

A. abolish High Courts B. suspend court enforcement of specified rights except 20/21 C. suspend the Constitution D. suspend Article 19 automatically

Answer: B.

The rights are not textually erased; enforcement is suspended as ordered.

OM15. Non-suspendable rights

Which pair is protected from Article 359 suspension?

A. 14 and 19 B. 19 and 22 C. 20 and 21 D. 21 and 32

Answer: C.

This was added by the 44th Amendment.

OM16. ADM Jabalpur (1976)

Current law treats it as:

A. partly controlling B. restored by 44th Amendment C. binding for habeas corpus D. wrongly decided and overruled by K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)

Answer: D.

Justice Khanna's dissent became constitutionally vindicated.

OM17. Historical declarations

National Emergency has been proclaimed:

A. three times B. once C. five times D. never

Answer: A.

1962, 1971 and 1975.

OM18. Article 356 trigger

President's Rule may be based on:

A. only Supreme Court advice B. Governor report or otherwise C. only ECI certificate D. Lok Sabha no-confidence

Answer: B.

The constitutional test is inability to carry on State government according to Constitution.

OM19. 356 approval

Both Houses approve within:

A. six months simple majority B. one month special majority C. two months simple majority D. two months special majority

Answer: C.

Each continuation is six months.

OM20. 356 maximum

Ordinary constitutional maximum is:

A. five years B. indefinite C. one year D. three years

Answer: D.

Beyond one year requires Emergency plus ECI certification.

OM21. Beyond one year

Extension requires:

A. National Emergency condition plus ECI certification B. Supreme Court permission C. State referendum D. Governor request alone

Answer: A.

Both constitutional conditions must be met.

OM22. S.R. Bommai (1994) floor test

Disputed majority should ordinarily be tested:

A. by ECI B. on Assembly floor C. in Rajya Sabha D. by Governor interview

Answer: B.

Raj Bhavan assessment is not a substitute.

OM23. Assembly dissolution

S.R. Bommai (1994) requires:

A. State consent B. no suspension C. no dissolution before parliamentary approval D. immediate dissolution

Answer: C.

Courts can restore an improperly dismissed government/Assembly.

OM24. Article 356 and rights

Which is correct?

A. Article 21 is suspended. B. Article 19 automatically suspends. C. Article 359 always applies. D. President's Rule has no direct Fundamental Rights suspension.

Answer: D.

Do not merge Articles 352 and 356.

OM25. Financial trigger

Article 360 concerns threat to:

A. financial stability or credit of India or part B. municipal finances only C. national security only D. State majority

Answer: A.

The trigger is broad but financial.

OM26. Financial duration

Once approved, it:

A. ends in one year B. continues indefinitely without renewal C. needs six-month special-majority renewal D. requires State ratification

Answer: B.

It may be revoked by the President.

OM27. Financial consequences

Which may be directed?

A. abolition of Finance Commission B. Suspension of Article 19 C. salary reductions including SC/HC judges D. Dissolution of High Courts

Answer: C.

State Money Bills can also be required to be reserved.

OM28. Financial status

As of the control date, Financial Emergency has:

A. been used during COVID-19 B. been proclaimed once C. been used in 1991 D. never been proclaimed

Answer: D.

Economic crisis does not equal Article 360 proclamation.

Remedial MCQ loop - strict A -> A -> B -> D rotation

RM1. Ground

The internal ground under Article 352 is:

A. armed rebellion B. internal disturbance C. public disorder D. State failure

Answer: A.

Internal disturbance remains in Article 355, not Article 352.

RM2. Majority

Article 356 approval uses:

A. special majority B. simple majority C. joint sitting D. State ratification

Answer: B.

Only National Emergency uses the special majority among the three.

RM3. Rights

Article 358 operates during:

A. Financial Emergency B. armed rebellion only C. war/external aggression Emergency D. President's Rule

Answer: C.

It automatically affects Article 19 subject to post-44th limits.

RM4. Liberty

Which can never be suspended through Article 359?

A. 32/226 B. 14/15 C. 19/22 D. 20/21

Answer: D.

Life, liberty and penal protections remain enforceable.

RM5. S.R. Bommai (1994)

The correct majority forum is:

A. Assembly floor B. Governor's office C. Supreme Court facts hearing first D. Rajya Sabha

Answer: A.

Floor test is the default democratic mechanism.

RM6. High Court

During President's Rule:

A. High Court is dissolved B. High Court remains constitutionally untouched by assumption C. Chief Justice reports to Parliament D. President assumes High Court functions

Answer: B.

Article 356 expressly protects High Court functions.

RM7. Article 360

Its parliamentary approval window is:

A. six months B. one month C. two months D. one year

Answer: C.

Simple majority in both Houses.

RM8. Article 360 use

India has:

A. used it in 1962 B. used it in 1991 C. used it in 1975 D. never proclaimed it

Answer: D.

The severity helps explain its non-use.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Routed PYQs with model solutions

PYQ 1 - UPSC GS-II 2018, Q3 - direct

Question: Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration remains in force? **10 marks | 150 words**

Demand decoding: Under what circumstances requires Article 360's trigger, procedure and consequences, followed by the never-used qualified verdict.

Model solution

Article 360 permits the President to proclaim Financial Emergency when satisfied that the financial stability or credit of India or any part is threatened.

Both Houses must approve within two months by simple majority. It then continues without periodic renewal and may be revoked by the President.

Its consequences are strongly centralising. Union executive power extends to directing States to observe canons of financial propriety and other necessary measures. Directions may require reduction of salaries and allowances of persons serving a State and reservation of State Money Bills or specified financial Bills for presidential consideration. The President may also direct salary reductions for persons serving Union affairs, including Supreme Court and High Court judges.

The provision sharply centralises finance without suspending Fundamental Rights or abolishing State institutions. It has never been invoked, reflecting its severity.

Thus, Article 360 is a last-resort stabilisation power whose constitutional legitimacy depends on necessity, proportionality and review.

Why this earns marks: It states the constitutional threshold, approval, duration and every major direction without confusing Financial Emergency with ordinary fiscal stress.

How to improve this answer: Use a trigger -> approval -> consequences -> status flow; omit 1991 detail if the 150-word limit is tight.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration...".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Article 360 permits the President to proclaim Financial Emergency when satisfied that the financial stability or credit of India or any part is threatened. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Both Houses must approve within two months by simple majority. It then continues without periodic renewal and may be revoked by the President. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The provision sharply centralises finance without suspending Fundamental Rights or abolishing State institutions. It has never been invoked, reflecting its severity. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Thus, Article 360 is a last-resort stabilisation power whose constitutional legitimacy depends on necessity, proportionality and review. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It states the constitutional threshold, approval, duration and every major direction without confusing Financial Emergency with ordinary fiscal stress. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Under what circumstances can the Financial Emergency be proclaimed by the President of India? What consequences follow when such a declaration...".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2018, Q53 - direct

Question: If the President of India exercises power under Article 356 in respect of a particular State, then:

- A. The State Assembly is automatically dissolved. B. The powers of the State Legislature shall be exercisable by or under the authority of Parliament. C. Article 19 is suspended in that State. D. The President can personally make every law relating to that State without parliamentary authority.

Answer: B. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED.

Article 356 permits declaration that State legislative powers are exercisable by or under Parliament's authority. The Assembly may be suspended rather than automatically dissolved, and Fundamental Rights are not automatically affected.

Demand decoding: Treat "If the President of India exercises power under Article 356 in respect of a particular State,..." as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "If the President of India exercises power under Article 356 in respect of a particular State, then: A. The State Assembly is automatically dissolved....".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The State Assembly is automatically dissolved. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** B. The powers of the State Legislature shall be exercisable by or under the authority of Parliament. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** D. The President can personally make every law relating to that State without parliamentary authority. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Answer: B. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "If the President of India exercises power under Article 356 in respect of a particular State, then: A. The State Assembly is automatically dissolved....".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For "If the President of India exercises power under Article 356 in respect of a particular State,...", state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

PYQ 3 - UPSC GS-II 2020, Q11 - supporting/cross-owned

Question: The Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity of the nation. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897, the Disaster Management Act, 2005 and the recently passed Farm Acts. **15 marks | 250 words**

Demand decoding: Elucidate requires showing centralising capacity through the named laws while distinguishing ordinary legislation from formal Emergency powers.

Model solution

India's holding-together Constitution gives the Union crisis and common-market capacity beyond a classical federation.

During COVID-19, the Union used the Disaster Management Act, 2005 for national directions, while the Epidemic Diseases Act operated through State authorities. Central coordination enabled uniform movement, procurement and containment rules, but public health is substantially a State field and implementation burdens rested on States.

The 2020 Farm Acts relied on Concurrent Entry 33 concerning trade in foodstuffs but affected agriculture and markets under State Entries 14 and 28. Their enactment without adequate federal consultation became a competence and trust dispute. Repeal in 2021 demonstrated political federalism.

Emergency provisions strengthen this tendency: Article 352 permits Union directions and State-field legislation; Article 356 transfers State legislative authority; Article 360 centralises financial directions. Yet these were not the direct legal basis of the Farm Acts.

The counterbalance lies in *S.R. Bommai (1994)*, judicial competence doctrines, parliamentary accountability, GST/ISC consultation and State electoral power.

Thus, centralising authority may protect unity, but ordinary statutes should not borrow emergency logic. Necessity, correct List entry and structured State consultation distinguish coordination from coercion.

Why this earns marks: It discusses each named statute, locates the federal competence dispute and balances Union coordination with State consultation.

How to improve this answer: Give the three named statutes separate lines and explicitly say Articles 352-360 were not the direct legal basis of the Farm Acts.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "The Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity of the nation. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic...".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ 3 - UPSC GS-II 2020, Q11 - supporting/cross-owned **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** India's holding-together Constitution gives the Union crisis and common-market capacity beyond a classical federation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The counterbalance lies in S.R. Bommai (1994) , judicial competence doctrines, parliamentary accountability, GST/ISC consultation and State electoral power. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Thus, centralising authority may protect unity, but ordinary statutes should not borrow emergency logic. Necessity, correct List entry and structured State consultation distinguish coordination from coercion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It discusses each named statute, locates the federal competence dispute and balances Union coordination with State consultation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "The Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity of the nation. Elucidate in the perspective of the Epidemic...".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

PYQ 4 - UPSC Prelims 2023, Q77 - direct

Question: Consider the following statements:

1. According to the Constitution, the Central Government has a duty to protect States from internal disturbances.
2. The Constitution exempts the States from providing legal counsel to a person being held for preventive detention.
3. According to the Prevention of Terrorism Act, 2002, confession of an accused before police cannot be used as evidence.

How many statements are correct?

A. Only one B. Only two C. All three D. None

Answer: B. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED.

Article 355 establishes the Union duty. Article 22(3) excludes preventive-detention cases from clauses (1) and (2), including counsel/arrest-production safeguards. POTA allowed specified police confessions as evidence; it was repealed in 2004.

Demand decoding: Treat "Consider the following statements: 1. According to the Constitution, the Central Government..." as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Consider the following statements: 1. According to the Constitution, the Central Government has a duty to protect States from internal disturbances....".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** According to the Constitution, the Central Government has a duty to protect States from internal disturbances. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Constitution exempts the States from providing legal counsel to a person being held for preventive detention. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** According to the Prevention of Terrorism Act, 2002, confession of an accused before police cannot be used as evidence. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Answer: B. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Consider the following statements: 1. According to the Constitution, the Central Government has a duty to protect States from internal disturbances....".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For "Consider the following statements: 1. According to the Constitution, the Central Government...", state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

PYQ 5 - UPSC GS-II 2023, Q13 - direct

Question: Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since the mid-1990s. **15 marks | 250 words**

Demand decoding: Account for requires causal explanation of both legal and political reasons for declining Article 356 use.

Model solution

Article 356 declined after the mid-1990s because judicial doctrine and political federalisation raised the cost of partisan dismissal.

Legal watershed: *S.R. Bommai (1994)* made proclamations judicially reviewable, required relevant material, placed majority testing on the Assembly floor, prevented dissolution before parliamentary approval and allowed restoration after invalid action. *Rameshwar Prasad (2006)* reinforced review by finding the Bihar dissolution unconstitutional.

Political change: Coalition Union governments after 1989 often depended on regional parties. Strong State-based parties increased parliamentary and electoral costs of dismissing opposition governments. Greater media and civil-society scrutiny also raised reputational cost.

Institutional norms: Sarkaria and Punchhi recommended warning, floor tests, speaking Governor reports and last-resort use. Although not binding, they shaped constitutional expectations.

The decline is not attributable to textual repeal: Article 356 retains broad "report or otherwise" language and Governor disputes continue. Rather, law altered litigation risk while political federalism altered survival incentives.

Thus, Article 356 moved from a routine partisan instrument toward an exceptional constitutional remedy through the combined discipline of courts, coalitions and conventions.

Why this earns marks: It combines *S.R. Bommai (1994)* and *Rameshwar Prasad (2006)* with coalition, regional-party and commission factors, then qualifies the continuing Governor problem.

How to improve this answer: Use Legal, Political and Institutional subheads; retain *Rameshwar Prasad (2006)*'s non-restoration limit if adding case detail.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since the mid-1990s."

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Article 356 declined after the mid-1990s because judicial doctrine and political federalisation raised the cost of partisan dismissal. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Institutional norms: Sarkaria and Punchhi recommended warning, floor tests, speaking Governor reports and last-resort use. Although not binding, they shaped constitutional expectations. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Thus, Article 356 moved from a routine partisan instrument toward an exceptional constitutional remedy through the combined discipline of courts, coalitions and conventions. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It combines S.R. Bommai (1994) and Rameshwar Prasad (2006) with coalition, regional-party and commission factors, then qualifies the continuing Governor problem. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** How to improve this answer: Use Legal, Political and Institutional subheads; retain Rameshwar Prasad (2006)'s non-restoration limit if adding case detail. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Account for the legal and political factors responsible for the reduced frequency of using Article 356 by the Union Governments since the mid-1990s."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

PYQ 6 - UPSC Prelims 2024, Q74 - supporting, official key

Question: Which of the following statements about the Constitution are correct?

1. Powers of Municipalities are given in Part IX-A.
2. Emergency provisions are given in Part XVIII.
3. Constitutional amendment provisions are given in Part XX.

Select the correct answer:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D. OFFICIAL UPSC SET-A KEY.

All three Part references are correct.

Original Mains practice with examiner-grade models

Demand decoding: Treat "Which of the following statements about the Constitution are correct? 1. Powers of..." as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Which of the following statements about the Constitution are correct? 1. Powers of Municipalities are given in Part IX-A. 2. Emergency provisions are..."

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ 6 - UPSC Prelims 2024, Q74 - supporting, official key **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Powers of Municipalities are given in Part IX-A. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Emergency provisions are given in Part XVIII. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy

implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Constitutional amendment provisions are given in Part XX. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Original Mains practice with examiner-grade models **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Which of the following statements about the Constitution are correct? 1. Powers of Municipalities are given in Part IX-A. 2. Emergency provisions are..."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For "Which of the following statements about the Constitution are correct? 1. Powers of...", state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

M1. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain the written-Cabinet, parliamentary and Lok Sabha safeguards governing a National Emergency.

Demand decoding: Explain the three safeguards and show how each checks executive initiation or continuation.

Model solution

Article 352 now combines executive initiation with strong parliamentary checks.

First, the President cannot proclaim Emergency unless the Union Cabinet's decision is communicated in writing. This prevents prime-ministerial or informal advice from substituting for collective Cabinet responsibility.

Second, both Houses must approve within one month through a special majority: majority of total membership and at least two-thirds present and voting. Continuation requires the same majority every six months, preventing an open-ended executive proclamation.

Third, Lok Sabha possesses a special exit mechanism. The President must revoke if the House passes a simple-majority disapproval resolution. At least one-tenth of Lok Sabha members may requisition a special sitting within 14 days.

Finally, presidential satisfaction is judicially reviewable after removal of the 38th Amendment immunity.

These 44th Amendment safeguards respond directly to 1975. They preserve rapid crisis action but require written collective advice, recurring legislative legitimacy, lower-House control and constitutional review.

Why this earns marks: It gives written Cabinet advice, special-majority renewal, Lok Sabha exit and restored review in a compact sequence.

How to improve this answer: Draw four boxes in rough work and keep the special-majority definition exact.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Explain the written-Cabinet, parliamentary and Lok Sabha safeguards governing a National Emergency."

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 352 now combines executive initiation with strong parliamentary checks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** First, the President cannot proclaim Emergency unless the Union Cabinet's decision is communicated in writing. This prevents prime-ministerial or informal advice from substituting for collective Cabinet responsibility. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Finally, presidential satisfaction is judicially reviewable after removal of the 38th Amendment immunity. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** These 44th Amendment safeguards respond directly to 1975. They preserve rapid crisis action but require written collective advice, recurring legislative legitimacy, lower-House control and constitutional review. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It gives written Cabinet advice, special-majority renewal, Lok Sabha exit and restored review in a compact sequence. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Explain the written-Cabinet, parliamentary and Lok Sabha safeguards governing a National Emergency."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M2. 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Differentiate Articles 358 and 359 and explain the significance of the protection of Articles 20 and 21.

Demand decoding: Differentiate requires a side-by-side 358/359 comparison and the significance of the 20/21 firewall.

Model solution

Article 358 operates automatically and concerns only Article 19. After the 44th Amendment, it applies only to Emergency based on war or external aggression, not armed rebellion, and protects only emergency-related laws carrying the required recital and action under them.

Article 359 requires a presidential order. It suspends the right to move specified courts for enforcement of named Fundamental Rights for the stated period and territory; it does not automatically suspend every right.

Articles 20 and 21 are constitutionally excluded from Article 359. Protection against retrospective punishment, double jeopardy and compelled self-incrimination, along with life and personal liberty, remain enforceable.

This protection answers *ADM Jabalpur (1976)*, whose majority denied habeas corpus during the 1975 Emergency. *K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)* overruled it.

Thus, Article 358 creates a narrow automatic Article 19 rule; Article 359 creates a specified enforcement restriction, bounded by an inviolable liberty core.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes trigger, operation, rights and legal effect, then connects ADM Jabalpur (1976) to K.S. Puttaswamy (2017).

How to improve this answer: Avoid saying rights are abolished or suspended generally; use 'Article 19 limits do not apply' and 'right to move court is suspended'.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Differentiate Articles 358 and 359 and explain the significance of the protection of Articles 20 and 21."

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 359 requires a presidential order. It suspends the right to move specified courts for enforcement of named Fundamental Rights for the stated period and territory; it does not automatically suspend every right. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Articles 20 and 21 are constitutionally excluded from Article 359. Protection against retrospective punishment, double jeopardy and compelled self-incrimination, along with life and personal liberty, remain enforceable. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** This protection answers ADM Jabalpur (1976), whose majority denied habeas corpus during the 1975 Emergency. K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) overruled it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Thus, Article 358 creates a narrow automatic Article 19 rule; Article 359 creates a specified enforcement restriction, bounded by an inviolable liberty core. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It distinguishes trigger, operation, rights and legal effect, then connects ADM Jabalpur (1976) to K.S. Puttaswamy (2017). **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Differentiate Articles 358 and 359 and explain the significance of the protection of Articles 20 and 21."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M3. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "Emergency provisions make the Indian federation unitary without formally abolishing States." Examine.

Demand decoding: Examine requires testing temporary functional centralisation separately under Articles 352, 356 and 360.

Model solution

The statement captures the temporary centralisation enabled by Part XVIII, but each emergency changes federalism differently.

Under Article 352, Union executive directions extend broadly, Parliament legislates on the State List and Article 354 can modify revenue distribution. State legislatures and governments nevertheless continue; Union competence becomes temporarily dominant rather than States being abolished.

Under Article 356, centralisation is sharper within the affected State. The Council of Ministers is dismissed and State legislative power becomes exercisable by or under Parliament. Yet the High Court remains untouched, parliamentary approval is required and the State's legal identity continues.

Article 360 centralises financial direction: the Union may prescribe financial propriety, salary reductions and reservation of State financial Bills. It does not itself dismiss State institutions.

Post-1978 safeguards qualify the unitary transformation. National Emergency requires written Cabinet advice, special-majority renewal and Lok Sabha disapproval control. Articles 20 and 21 remain enforceable. *S.R. Bommai (1994)* makes Article 356 reviewable, prioritises floor tests and permits restoration.

Therefore, Emergency creates temporary functional unitarism within a continuing federal Constitution. The provisions are legitimate as a safety-valve only where necessity, parliamentary control, rights protection and judicial review prevent exceptional power from becoming ordinary governance.

Why this earns marks: It explains different institutional effects and balances them with the 44th Amendment and *S.R. Bommai (1994)* safeguards.

How to improve this answer: Use one paragraph per emergency and replace 'unitary' with 'temporarily Union-weighted' in the conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in ""Emergency provisions make the Indian federation unitary without formally abolishing States." Examine.".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The statement captures the temporary centralisation enabled by Part XVIII, but each emergency changes federalism differently. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Article 360 centralises financial direction: the Union may prescribe financial propriety, salary reductions and reservation of State financial Bills. It does not itself dismiss State institutions. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It explains different institutional effects and balances them with the 44th Amendment and *S.R. Bommai (1994)* safeguards. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** How to improve this answer: Use one paragraph per emergency and replace 'unitary' with 'temporarily Union-weighted' in the conclusion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in ""Emergency provisions make the Indian federation unitary without formally abolishing States." Examine.".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M4. 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Assess the constitutional significance of S.R. Bommai (1994) beyond merely reducing misuse of Article 356.

Demand decoding: Assess significance beyond frequency by identifying S.R. Bommai (1994)'s federal, democratic, remedial and secularism doctrines.

Model solution

S.R. Bommai (1994) transformed Article 356 and clarified the nature of Indian constitutional democracy.

First, it subjected presidential satisfaction to judicial review. Relevant material, absence of mala fides and constitutional purpose became legal requirements, rejecting the view that Article 356 was purely political.

Second, it constitutionalised the floor test as the ordinary method for deciding legislative majority. This protects the Assembly's democratic authority from subjective Governor assessment.

Third, it limited irreversible action: the Assembly should not be dissolved before Parliament approves the proclamation, and courts may restore an unlawfully dismissed government and House.

Fourth, the Court identified federalism and secularism as Basic Structure features. Article 356 can therefore protect the constitutional order against genuinely anti-secular State action, but cannot become a partisan weapon against opposition governments.

Fifth, the burden placed on the Union to produce supporting material strengthened reason-giving and accountability.

The judgment's reach extends beyond frequency statistics. It links federalism, representative majority, judicial review, secularism and remedial restoration. Later cases such as *Rameshwar Prasad (2006)* demonstrate continued scrutiny of Governor-based material.

Thus, *S.R. Bommai (1994)* did not merely tame a provision; it converted emergency federalism into a justiciable branch of constitutional morality.

Why this earns marks: It covers review, floor test, dissolution, restoration, Basic Structure and burden of producing material.

How to improve this answer: Add *Rameshwar Prasad (2006)*'s invalidation-without-restoration qualification as the best later application.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Assess the constitutional significance of S.R. Bommai (1994) beyond merely reducing misuse of Article 356.".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** S.R. Bommai (1994) transformed Article 356 and clarified the nature of Indian constitutional democracy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** First, it subjected presidential satisfaction to judicial review. Relevant material, absence of mala fides and constitutional purpose became legal requirements, rejecting the view that Article 356 was purely political. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Second, it constitutionalised the floor test as the ordinary method for deciding legislative majority. This protects the Assembly's democratic authority from subjective Governor assessment. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Third, it limited irreversible action: the Assembly should not be dissolved before Parliament approves the proclamation, and courts may restore an unlawfully dismissed government and House. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Fifth, the burden placed on the Union to produce supporting material strengthened reason-giving and accountability. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Assess the constitutional significance of S.R. Bommai (1994) beyond merely reducing misuse of Article 356."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M5. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: Critically evaluate whether the 44th Amendment adequately prevents repetition of the constitutional abuses associated with the 1975 Emergency.

Demand decoding: Critically evaluate requires achievements, residual vulnerabilities and a graded adequacy verdict.

Model solution

The 44th Amendment directly repaired major vulnerabilities exposed in 1975.

It replaced "internal disturbance" with the narrower "armed rebellion," required written Cabinet advice, reduced the approval period to one month and imposed a special majority. Six-month renewal prevents passive continuation. Lok Sabha disapproval forces revocation, while one-tenth of members can requisition a special sitting.

Rights protection was equally important. Article 358 was confined to external Emergency and emergency-related laws. Article 359 can never block enforcement of Articles 20 and 21. The amendment removed the 38th Amendment's satisfaction immunity, restoring judicial review. *K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)*'s overruling of *ADM Jabalpur (1976)* supplies jurisprudential reinforcement.

However, no text eliminates abuse. A disciplined parliamentary majority may approve executive action; threat information remains controlled by government; preventive detention and censorship can operate through ordinary statutes; institutions may defer during perceived crisis. National Emergency can still be renewed indefinitely.

Prevention therefore also depends on opposition capacity, free media, independent courts, reasoned Cabinet material and political memory. Official commemoration of Emergency abuse may strengthen memory but is not a legal safeguard.

The 44th Amendment substantially closes the exact 1975 pathways, especially vague grounds and denial of life/liberty remedies. It cannot guarantee democratic courage. Its adequacy is institutional rather than automatic: strong text must be activated by Parliament, courts and citizens.

Why this earns marks: It maps each 1975 vulnerability to a 44th Amendment repair and recognises institutional limits that text cannot eliminate.

How to improve this answer: Prioritise armed rebellion, Cabinet writing, special-majority renewal and 20/21 protection; compress commemorative material.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Critically evaluate whether the 44th Amendment adequately prevents repetition of the constitutional abuses associated with the 1975 Emergency."

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The 44th Amendment directly repaired major vulnerabilities exposed in 1975. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It maps each 1975 vulnerability to a 44th Amendment repair and recognises institutional limits that text cannot eliminate. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** How to improve this answer: Prioritise armed rebellion, Cabinet writing, special-majority renewal and 20/21 protection; compress commemorative material. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Critically evaluate whether the 44th Amendment adequately prevents repetition of the constitutional abuses associated with the 1975 Emergency."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M6. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: Why has Article 360 never been invoked despite serious economic crises? Does non-use indicate redundancy?

Demand decoding: Why and redundancy require explaining non-use through severity, alternatives and retained contingency value.

Model solution

Article 360 permits Financial Emergency when India's financial stability or credit, or that of any part, is threatened. Its non-use reflects severity and availability of alternatives, not necessarily redundancy.

Once approved by simple majority within two months, it continues indefinitely. Union directions may prescribe financial propriety, reduce salaries of State and Union personnel including constitutional-court judges, and require State Money Bills to be reserved. Such measures deeply centralise fiscal federalism and can undermine judicial and administrative independence perceptions.

India managed the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis through devaluation, external assistance, fiscal adjustment and economic reform; later shocks used monetary, fiscal, disaster and borrowing instruments. Article 293 conditions, Finance Commission transfers, RBI action and Union budgets provide less constitutionally dramatic tools.

Political economy also discourages invocation. The proclamation publicly signals exceptional loss of financial credibility and distributes austerity through direct central command. Judicial review and parliamentary debate add accountability.

Non-use therefore demonstrates a high activation threshold and preference for ordinary institutions. Yet the provision retains contingency value where systemic collapse prevents normal fiscal coordination.

Reform could require published reasons, periodic parliamentary renewal rather than indefinite continuation, an independent fiscal assessment and protection for judicial remuneration.

Article 360 is a constitutional fire alarm: rarely or never used because activation itself signals catastrophe. Its legitimacy lies in last-resort availability, but its indefinite duration deserves scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: It accurately sets out Article 360, compares ordinary fiscal tools and gives a balanced reform-oriented conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Do not call 1991 a near-proclamation; call it a crisis managed without Article 360.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Why has Article 360 never been invoked despite serious economic crises? Does non-use indicate redundancy?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 360 permits Financial Emergency when India's financial stability or credit, or that of any part, is threatened. Its non-use reflects severity and availability of alternatives, not necessarily redundancy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Non-use therefore demonstrates a high activation threshold and preference for ordinary institutions. Yet the provision retains contingency value where systemic collapse prevents normal fiscal coordination. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Reform could require published reasons, periodic parliamentary renewal rather than indefinite continuation, an independent fiscal assessment and protection for judicial remuneration. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Article 360 is a constitutional fire alarm: rarely or never used because activation itself signals catastrophe. Its legitimacy lies in last-resort availability, but its indefinite duration deserves scrutiny. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It accurately sets out Article 360, compares ordinary fiscal tools and gives a balanced reform-oriented conclusion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Why has Article 360 never been invoked despite serious economic crises? Does non-use indicate redundancy?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

M7. 20 marks | 250-300 words

Question: Emergency powers are necessary for constitutional survival but dangerous when crisis reasoning enters ordinary governance. Discuss.

Demand decoding: Discuss requires a necessity-versus-normalisation dialectic with safeguards and a constitutional-survival test.

Model solution

A Constitution must respond to war, rebellion, State breakdown and financial collapse. Ordinary allocation may be too slow or fragmented; Emergency provisions therefore concentrate authority to preserve sovereignty and constitutional government.

Necessity is evident in Article 352's defence coordination, Article 356's response to genuine constitutional impossibility and Article 360's potential stabilisation of systemic finance. Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar's "life-breath" and Mahabir Tyagi's "safety-valve" capture this case.

The danger is normalisation. The 1975 Emergency showed how vague "internal disturbance," executive dominance, detention and blocked judicial remedies could turn legal power into constitutional dictatorship. Similar reasoning can enter ordinary governance when disaster statutes, preventive detention or central directions bypass consultation.

India's safeguards now distinguish exception from normality: armed rebellion is narrow; Cabinet advice must be written; Article 352 needs special-majority renewal; Lok Sabha can force revocation; Articles 20 and 21 remain enforceable; *S.R. Bommai (1994)* and *K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)* reject executive finality.

Yet institutions must actively enforce these rules. Parliament requires information, courts must remain accessible, media must remain free and emergency-related laws must show genuine nexus and proportionality.

Emergency power is therefore legitimate only as temporary constitutional self-defence. The decisive test is whether exceptional authority restores ordinary democratic government or becomes a convenient model for governing without it.

Why this earns marks: It uses all three emergencies, 1975 evidence, amendments and cases to reach a qualified temporary-self-defence standard.

How to improve this answer: Keep ordinary disaster/preventive-detention examples subordinate and end with restoration of normal government as the decisive test.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Emergency powers are necessary for constitutional survival but dangerous when crisis reasoning enters ordinary governance. Discuss."

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Yet institutions must actively enforce these rules. Parliament requires information, courts must remain accessible, media must remain free and emergency-related laws must show genuine nexus and proportionality. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It uses all three emergencies, 1975 evidence, amendments and cases to reach a qualified temporary-self-defence standard. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** How to improve this answer: Keep ordinary disaster/preventive-detention examples subordinate and end with restoration of normal government as the decisive test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power,

agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Emergency powers are necessary for constitutional survival but dangerous when crisis reasoning enters ordinary governance. Discuss."

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

16. Safety-valve versus constitutional dictatorship - optional

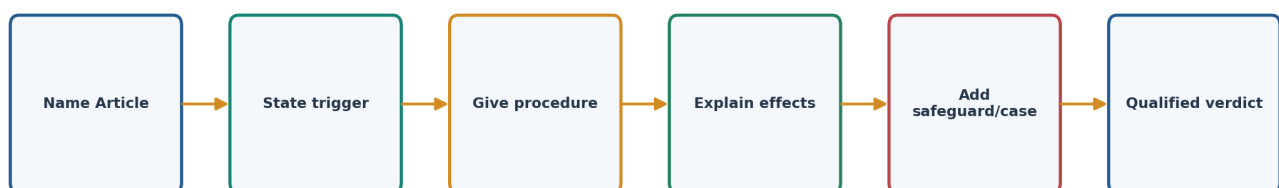
Critic/defender	Argument use
H.V. Kamath	Risk of totalitarian/police State
K.T. Shah	Reaction and retrogression
T.T. Krishnamachari	Constitutional dictatorship warning
H.N. Kunzru	Financial Emergency threat to State autonomy
Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar	Emergency provisions as life-breath
Mahabir Tyagi	Safety-valve necessary for constitutional survival

- [ANALYSIS] Both sides are partly correct: a Constitution needs crisis capacity, but unchecked crisis power can destroy the order it claims to preserve.
- [ANALYSIS] The modern answer should judge the provisions together with 44th Amendment safeguards, judicial review and political federalism.

17. Constitutional dictatorship as a design problem - optional

- Emergency power concentrates authority temporarily under legal forms.
- The risk is normalisation: crisis standards may become ordinary governance.
- Procedural safeguards, sunset/renewal, reasons, parliamentary opposition, judicial access and protected rights prevent normalisation.
- India's strongest design choice is not merely special-majority approval but non-suspendable Articles 20 and 21.
- The remaining weakness is information asymmetry: Parliament and courts depend on executive material concerning threat and State breakdown.

Emergency answer spine



A high-scoring answer states the Article, trigger, procedure, effects, safeguard/case and a qualified verdict.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Three emergencies

- Article 352: war, external aggression, armed rebellion.
- Article 356: State government cannot be carried on according to Constitution.
- Article 360: threat to financial stability or credit of India or part.
- Part XVIII = Articles 352-360.

National Emergency procedure

- May cover whole or part; imminent danger sufficient.
- Written Union Cabinet decision mandatory.
- Approval within one month.
- Special majority in each House.
- Six-month blocks; no maximum.
- If Lok Sabha dissolved: Rajya Sabha approval + new Lok Sabha within 30 days of first sitting.
- President revokes anytime.
- Lok Sabha simple-majority disapproval forces revocation.
- One-tenth LS members can requisition special sitting within 14 days.

44th Amendment safeguards

- Internal disturbance -> armed rebellion.
- Cabinet advice in writing.
- One month + special majority.
- Lok Sabha disapproval route.
- Article 358 external-Emergency only.
- Articles 20 and 21 never suspended under 359.
- Judicial-review immunity removed.

National Emergency effects

- Union directions to States on any matter.
- Parliament legislates State List; law has six-month tail.
- President may issue State-subject ordinances.
- Article 354 revenue-distribution modification.
- LS/Assembly term extension one year at a time; max six months after cessation.
- States continue: functional centralisation, not abolition.

Articles 358 and 359

Test	358	359
Scope	Article 19	Specified rights except 20/21
Trigger	War/external aggression	Either Article 352 type
Operation	Automatic	Presidential order
Effect	Emergency-related State action freed from Article 19 limits	Court enforcement suspended as specified

- Required emergency-related recital/nexus matters post-44th.
- ADM Jabalpur (1976) majority denied habeas corpus; Khanna dissented.
- K.S. Puttaswamy (2017) overruled ADM Jabalpur (1976).

Historical control

- National Emergency: 1962, 1971, 1975.

- 38th Amendment: satisfaction immunity.
- 42nd: territorial/effect expansion.
- 44th: democratic safeguards.
- 25 June official observance is commemorative, not legal amendment.

President's Rule

- Governor report or otherwise.
- Approval within two months, simple majority.
- Six-month renewals; maximum three years.
- Beyond one year: National Emergency condition + ECI certification.
- CM/Council dismissed.
- State legislative power by/under Parliament.
- Assembly suspended or dissolved.
- High Court functions cannot be assumed.
- No direct FR suspension.
- State laws continue until altered.

S.R. Bommai (1994) propositions

- Judicial review.
- Relevant material; Union produces it.
- Floor test for majority.
- No dissolution before parliamentary approval.
- Court restoration possible.
- Federalism and secularism Basic Structure.
- Article 356 last resort.
- New Union majority cannot dismiss States merely for political difference.
- Rameshwar Prasad (2006): Bihar dissolution unconstitutional.

Decline after mid-1990s

- S.R. Bommai (1994) litigation risk.
- Floor-test norm.
- Coalition Union governments.
- Regional-party leverage.
- Sarkaria/Punchhi conventions.
- Media/civil society scrutiny.
- Text remained; incentives changed.

Financial Emergency

- Trigger: financial stability/credit threatened.
- Approval two months, simple majority.
- Indefinite; no renewal.
- President revokes.
- Canons of financial propriety.
- State salary reductions.
- State Money/financial Bills reserved.
- Union salary reductions including SC/HC judges.
- Never proclaimed; 1991 was not Article 360.

Rapid comparison

Test	352	356	360
Majority	Special	Simple	Simple
Renewal	6 monthly	6 monthly	None
Maximum	Indefinite	3 years	Indefinite
FR effect	358/359 possible	None direct	None direct
Core effect	National/federal	State machinery	Financial directions

PYQ routes

- 2018 Mains: Article 360 trigger -> procedure -> consequences -> never-used verdict.
- 2018 Prelims: State legislative power exercisable by/under Parliament.
- 2020 Mains: distinguish emergency power from ordinary centralising statutes.
- 2023 Prelims: Article 355 true; Article 22 preventive-detention exception; POTA statement false.
- 2023 Mains: S.R. Bommai (1994) + coalitions + regional parties + commissions.
- 2024 Prelims: Emergency provisions in Part XVIII.

Final trap checklist

- Internal disturbance is not Article 352 ground.
- Article 352 approval is one month and special majority.
- Article 356/360 approval is two months and simple majority.
- Article 352 can continue indefinitely by renewals.
- Article 356 maximum is three years.
- Article 360 is indefinite after approval, with no renewal.
- Article 358 = Article 19 + external Emergency only.
- Article 359 never covers Articles 20 and 21.
- ADM Jabalpur (1976) is overruled.
- Article 356 does not automatically dissolve Assembly.
- High Court cannot be assumed under Article 356.
- Article 365 is not automatic President's Rule.
- Financial Emergency has never been proclaimed.
- 1991 crisis was not Article 360.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Three emergencies and constitutional purpose

PART XVIII: ARTICLES 352-360

352 national security | 356 State constitutional breakdown | 360 financial stability

METHOD

trigger -> written advice/material -> parliamentary control -> duration -> effects -> exit

Emergency power preserves constitutional government; it is not an extra-constitutional regime.

MUST REMEMBER: Teach Articles 352-360 as three different regimes with exact triggers, approval periods, renewal, revocation, maximum duration, federal effects and rights consequences; Articles 358 and 359 must never be merged.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Article 352 trigger, approval, renewal and revocation

TRIGGER: war | external aggression | armed rebellion | imminent danger

Cabinet decision in writing -> President -> whole or part of India

APPROVAL: both Houses within one month -> special majority

CONTINUANCE: six-month blocks -> same special majority

EXIT: President revokes; Lok Sabha simple-majority disapproval requires revocation

One-tenth of Lok Sabha members can require a special sitting within 14 days.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Declaration and amendment chronology with current status

1962 external aggression -> revoked 1968

1971 external aggression -> continued alongside 1975 proclamation

1975 internal disturbance -> revoked 1977

38TH: attempted satisfaction immunity

42ND: territorial and wider-effect changes

44TH: armed rebellion, Cabinet writing, special majority, liberty and review

CURRENT 28 AUG 2026: no National Emergency is in force.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: National Emergency effects on federalism and institutions

ARTICLE 353: Union directions expand; Parliament gains State-field competence

ARTICLE 250 laws -> six-month tail after Emergency

ARTICLE 354 -> temporary revenue-distribution order with financial-year limit

LOK SABHA / ASSEMBLY TERMS -> Parliament may extend one year at a time

LIMIT

States, legislatures and High Courts continue: temporary Union weighting, not abolition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Articles 358 and 359 rights firewall

ARTICLE 358

automatic | Article 19 only | war/external aggression | emergency-related recital/action

ARTICLE 359

presidential order | named rights' court-enforcement route | stated area/period

PERMANENT FIREWALL

Articles 20 and 21 remain enforceable; unrelated illegality gets no emergency shield.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: ADM Jabalpur (1976), Khanna and K.S. Puttaswamy (2017)

ADM JABALPUR (1976) MAJORITY

denied habeas enforcement route during the operative Article 359 order

JUSTICE H.R. KHANNA -> liberty is not executive grace

44TH AMENDMENT -> Articles 20 and 21 excluded from Article 359

K.S. K.S. PUTTASWAMY (2017) -> ADM Jabalpur (1976) majority wrongly decided and overruled

Historical warning, not current law.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The 44th Amendment replaced internal disturbance with armed rebellion, requires written Cabinet advice, protects Articles 20 and 21, narrows Article 358 to war/external aggression and creates the Lok Sabha revocation route; Article 356 still has its own six-month approval cycle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: President's Rule mechanics and consequences

ARTICLE 356: Governor report or otherwise -> objective material -> proclamation

APPROVAL: two months, simple majority | renewal: six months | maximum: three years

BEYOND ONE YEAR: qualifying Article 352 Emergency + ECI certification

ARTICLE 357: Parliament may confer and permit delegation of State legislative power

Executive assumed; Assembly suspended/dissolved; High Court and Fundamental Rights continue

Article 365 may supply material, never an automatic trigger.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: S.R. Bommai (1994), Rameshwar Prasad (2006) and current Article 356 control

S.R. BOMMAI (1994)

review | relevant material | floor test | dissolution after approval | restoration | federalism

RAMESHWAR PRASAD (2006)

Bihar dissolution invalid; Assembly not restored because election process had advanced

WHY USE DECLINED

courts + coalitions + regional parties + Sarkaria/Punchhi norms

CURRENT: Manipur President's Rule 13 Feb 2025 -> revoked 4 Feb 2026.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Article 360 financial emergency

TRIGGER: financial stability or credit of India or any part threatened

APPROVAL: both Houses within two months by simple majority

DURATION: no periodic renewal; President may revoke

DIRECTIONS: financial propriety | salary reductions | State Money/financial Bills reserved

Union salary direction can include Supreme Court and High Court judges

STATUS: never proclaimed; 1991 was managed without Article 360.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Three-way comparison and last-resort alternatives

352: special majority | six-month renewal | national/federal/rights effects

356: simple majority | six-month renewal | three-year maximum | State machinery

360: simple majority | no renewal cycle | financial directions

ESCALATION LADDER

warning -> consultation -> floor test/court -> targeted ordinary law -> Emergency

Sarkaria and Punchhi recommendations guide restraint but are not binding law.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Six PYQs and Prelims firewalls

PYQ ROUTES

2018 Financial Emergency + Article 356 consequences

2020 centralising legislation | 2023 Article 355/detention/POTA + Article 356 decline

2024 Constitution-Part identification

FIREWALLS

armed rebellion != internal disturbance | 358 != 359 | 20/21 protected

352 special majority | 356/360 simple | 360 never used | High Court not assumed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Marks-scaled answer spine and qualified verdict

10 MARKS: provision -> trigger -> procedure -> effects -> status/verdict

15 MARKS: thesis -> legal factors -> political factors -> case/commission -> verdict

20 MARKS: 352 + rights + 356 + 360 -> safeguards -> limits -> graded conclusion

EVIDENCE CHAIN

claim -> Article/amendment -> mechanism -> case/history -> qualification

VERDICT: emergency is legitimate temporary constitutional self-defence only when reviewable and directed toward restoration of ordinary democratic government.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: As of 5 September 2026 no National or Financial Emergency was located in force. The Gazette proclamation of 4 February 2026 revoked the Manipur Article 356 proclamation; retain S.R. Bommai (1994) review and floor-test discipline without converting every political crisis into constitutional breakdown.